Technically, the Ruston Proctor Aerial Target was a small, powered monoplane equipped with an early radio control system, allowing it to be guided from the ground through transmitted commands. It was powered by an ABC Gnat engine, which provided sufficient thrust for short-duration flights. The design incorporated basic flight control surfaces rudders and elevators connected to servo mechanisms that responded to wireless control signals. The aircraft's airframe was constructed primarily from lightweight wood and fabric, maintaining aerodynamic simplicity and structural integrity suitable for experimental purposes.

The operational principle of the Aerial Target was straightforward yet groundbreaking: a ground-based operator used a radio transmitter to send coded pulses to the aircraft's receiver, which in turn activated the servomechanisms controlling its flight direction and altitude. Although the aircraft's range and stability were limited by the era's primitive radio technology, several successful test flights were conducted in 1917, confirming the feasibility of powered, unmanned flight under radio control (Wolf, 2021).

The significance of the Ruston Proctor Aerial Target lies in its status as one of the earliest successful demonstrations of a powered, pilotless aircraft. It not only validated A. M. Low's theoretical concepts of radioguided flight but also established the foundation for subsequent UAV projects, including the later "Aerial Target" prototypes and other first-generation drones. Furthermore, it represented a key technological bridge between balloon-based aerial systems and the more advanced autonomous aircraft that would emerge in later decades.

Figure 2.7 shows the *Ruston Proctor Aerial Target (1917)*, an early radio-controlled pilotless aircraft developed in the United Kingdom under the supervision of A. M. Low and constructed by the Ruston Proctor Aircraft